Same platform. Opposite reasons to buy.

The regulated security deal, stage by stage: what two buyers needed, how they decided, how long it took.

New York Life

Sal Picheria · Corporate VP, Security Engineering

Vanguard

Jonathan Reitnauer · Head of Cyber Security Detection & Orchestration

NYL · THE DEAL ON ONE TIMELINE

A two-year motion with a fast back end

EVALUATE

Survey, matrix, long POC

8-row market matrix · "buy both" vetoed by leadership · "a really long POC"

CHAMPION: THE DATA-PLATFORM OWNER

CUT OVER · OCT → MAR

6 months

2 Elastic services people · ~1-month parallel run · old SIEM off in March

CHAMPION: PLATFORM TEAM + THE SOC

EXPAND · YEAR ONE

20 teams, 200 users

Onboarding by Terraform · each run takes 10–15 minutes

CHAMPION: EVERY SECURITY SUB-TEAM

> "Took us two years to get there": NYL's end-to-end figure. The talk didn't split evaluation from build.

Source: NYL talk and slides, Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026. Champion lane: my read.

DIAGNOSE BEFORE THE FIRST DEMO

Maturity buyer or roadmap buyer?

	MATURITY · NYL	ROADMAP · VANGUARD
They said	A data model "around for a long period of time"	AI "very, very early" when they signed
Buying	Stability at petabyte scale	A co-builder that will "help build it"
Proof	A long POC on their own data	A roadmap "sneak peek"
Bring	Parity matrix, scale references	Design-partner access, product contacts
Contract	Stability terms + services	Roadmap commitments in writing

Row 1 and quotes: the talks, Oct 8, 2026. Rows 2–5: my read of them.

NYL · PRICING AS THE BUYER HEARS IT

Predictable beats cheap

INGEST-BASED

“You have to pick and choose what data is worth ingesting.”

Rationed data, blind spots

PAY-PER-QUERY

“Whoa, hold on. Don't run that.”

Rationed analytics, hesitant analysts

WHAT NYL WANTED

No dollar signs on the analytics people do

The model NYL landed on wasn't disclosed

Source: NYL talk, Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026.

VANGUARD · THE FUTURE SOC

AI executes. Humans govern.

01 · TRUSTED

Data foundation

Identity, endpoint, cloud, network and threat intel in one place

02 · AI POWERED

Execution

Triage, correlation, timelines and response recommendations

03 · GOVERNANCE

Human accountability

Risk decisions, sensitive containment, AI oversight

So bring the governance pack:

- An identity for every agent, with scoped permissions
- An audit log of what the AI queried and did
- An approval gate on anything that deploys
- A contract addendum mapped to their regulator

Source: Vanguard slide "The Future SOC: AI Executes, Humans Govern".
Checklist: my read.